

The Outsiders: Symbolism-to-Theme Mapping Matrix

Unit 4 — Symbolism & Characterization | English 8 Graphic Organizer

Student Name: _____

Date: _____

Class Period / Group: _____

Directions: Analyze how S.E. Hinton uses concrete objects as symbols to reflect abstract themes. For each symbol below, describe its context in the novel, provide a supporting quote/evidence, and explain its broader connection to a major theme.

Core Novel Symbol	Concrete Context in <i>The Outsiders</i>	Supporting Text Evidence / Quote	Abstract Theme Connection & Analysis
Greaser Hair & Haircuts <i>Long, slicked hair worn by East Side boys; cutting hair in Windrixville church.</i>			
Switchblades & Guns <i>Johnny carrying a knife after being beaten; Dally's unloaded 'heater'.</i>			
Socs' Cars & Rings <i>The Blue Mustang, Corvair, and Bob's heavy silver rings used in attacks.</i>			
Sunsets <i>Ponyboy and Cherry realized they both watch the sunset from different sides of town.</i>			
Gold ('Nothing Gold Can Stay') <i>Robert Frost poem read at the church; Johnny's final letter to Ponyboy.</i>			